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Title: Social Engineering Toolkit (SET)
and Reconnaissance

Exercise 3: Professional Phishing Campaigns with GoPhish

Objective

To configure and execute a simulated phishing campaign using GoPhish by creating an SMTP sending profile, email template, landing page, user group, and campaign, then monitoring campaign statistics through the GoPhish dashboard.

Procedure

Step 1: Start GoPhish

1. Open a terminal.
2. Navigate to the GoPhish directory.
3. Start the GoPhish server.

```
cd ~
```

```
./gophish
```

4. Verify that GoPhish starts successfully.

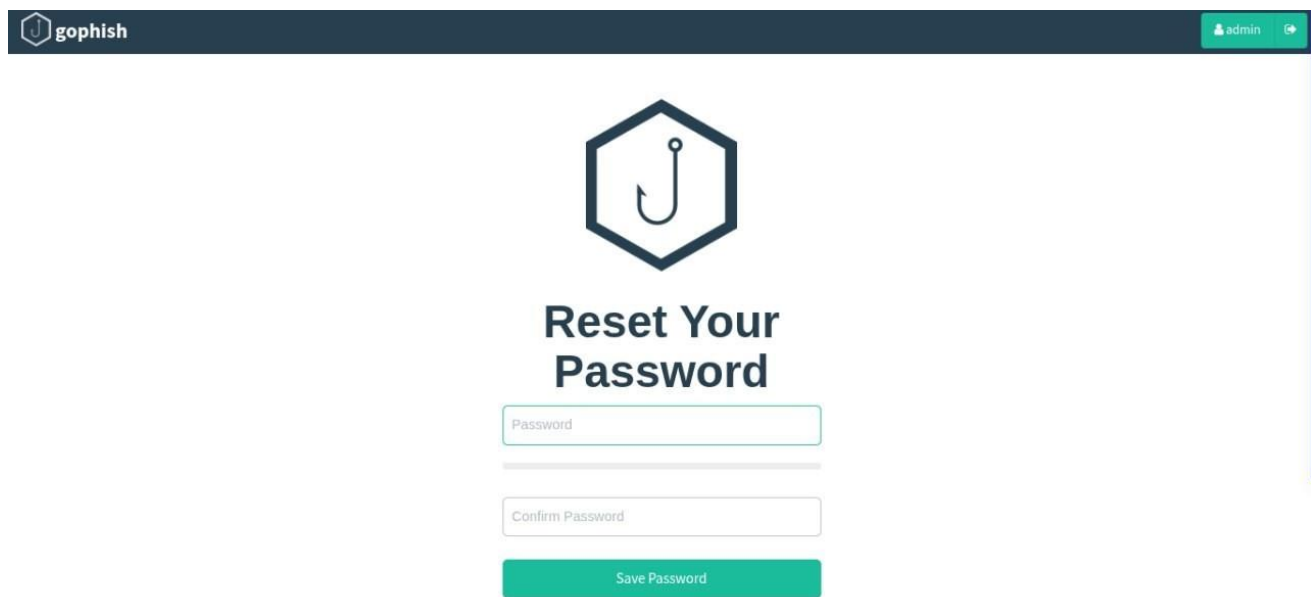
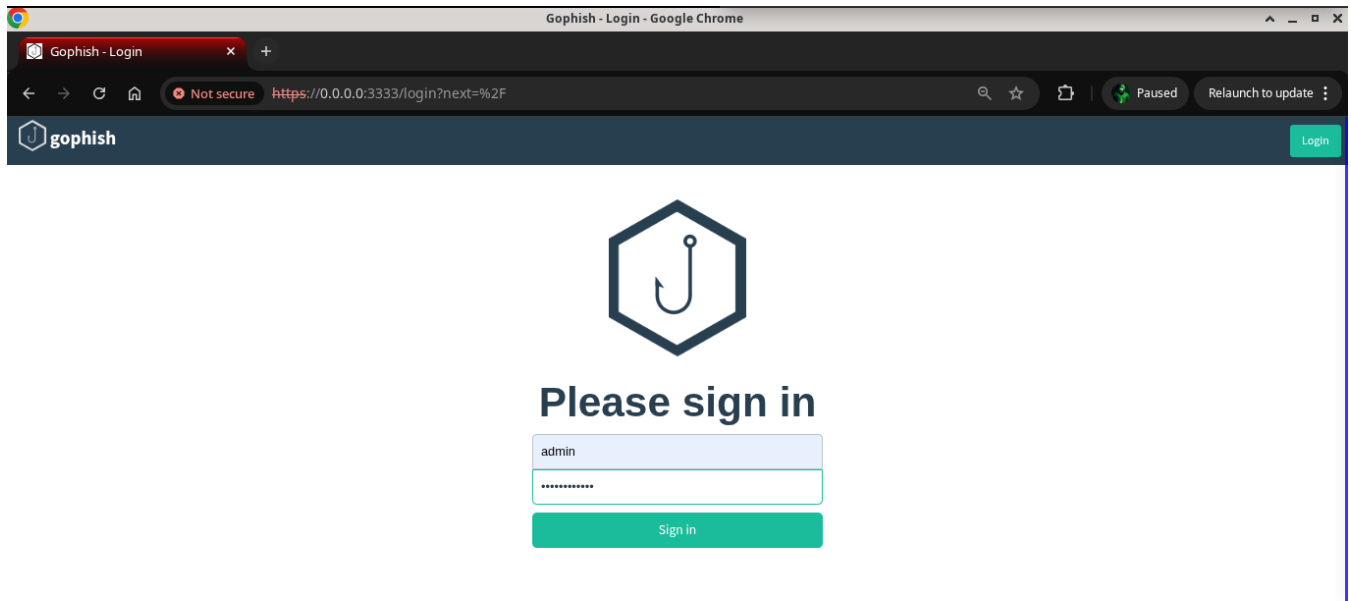
5. Open Firefox and browse to:

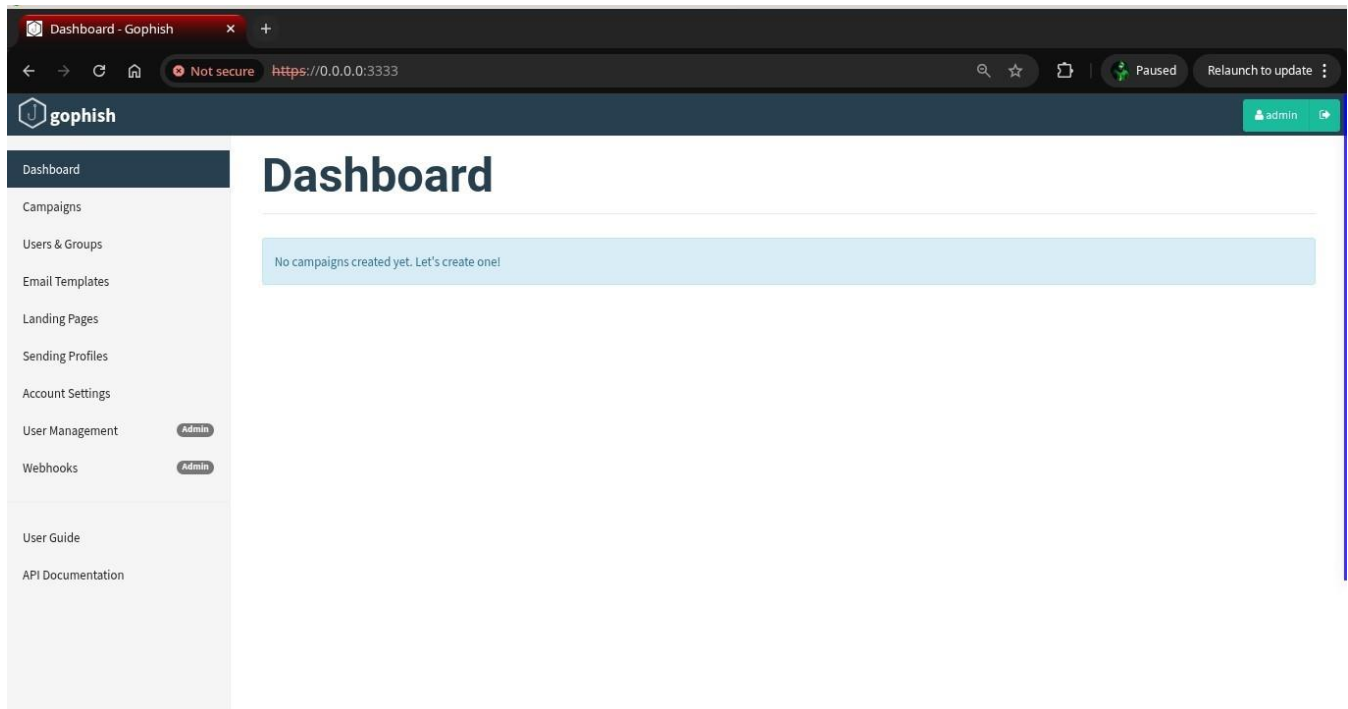
<https://127.0.0.1:3333>

6. Ignore the self-signed certificate warning.

7. Log in to the GoPhish administration dashboard.

```
fabrish@archlinux ~]$ ./gophish
time="2026-07-27T11:17:12Z" level=warning msg="No contact address has been configured."
time="2026-07-27T11:17:12Z" level=warning msg="Please consider adding a contact_address entry in your config.json"
goose: no migrations to run. current version: 20220321133237
time="2026-07-27T11:17:12Z" level=info msg="Starting admin server at https://0.0.0.0:3333"
time="2026-07-27T11:17:12Z" level=info msg="Starting phishing server at http://0.0.0.0:8080"
time="2026-07-27T11:17:12Z" level=info msg="Starting IMAP monitor manager"
time="2026-07-27T11:17:12Z" level=info msg="Starting new IMAP monitor for user admin"
time="2026-07-27T11:17:12Z" level=info msg="Background Worker Started Successfully - Waiting for Campaigns"
-
```





Step 2: Configure Sending Profile

1. Select **Sending Profiles**.
2. Click **New Profile**.
3. Configure then
4. Save the profile after confirming successful delivery.

gophish

admin

Dashboard

Campaigns

Users & Groups

Email Templates

Landing Pages

Sending Profiles

Account Settings

User ManagementAdmin

WebhooksAdmin

User Guide

API Documentation

Sending Profiles

Profile added successfully!

New Profile

Show10entriesSearch:

Name	Interface Type	Last Modified Date	
Local SMTP	SMTP	July 23rd 2026, 12:27:52 pm	

Showing 1 to 1 of 1 entries

Previous1Next

Edit Sending Profile

Name:

Local SMTP

Interface Type:

SMTP

SMTP From:

abrahamabebe1921@gmail.com

Host:

localhost:25

Username:

abrahamabebe1921@gmail.com

Password:

☐ Ignore Certificate Errors

Email Headers:

X-Custom-Header

{{URL}}-gophish

+ Add Custom Header

Show10entriesSearch:

Header	Value
No data available in table	

Showing 0 to 0 of 0 entries

PreviousNext

Send Test Email

CancelSave Profile

Step 3: Create an Email Template

1. Navigate to **Email Templates**.
2. Click **New Template**.
3. Configure:
 - Name: Google Security Alert
 - Subject: Action Required: Verify Your Google Account
4. Enable **Add Tracking Image**.
5. Create the email body containing a phishing link using:

Hello user, please click the link to secure your **account**. <https://learn.cylabacademy.org/get-started>

Name:

Fake Login Portal

 Import Email

Envelope Sender: 

Abreham Abebe <test@google.com>

Subject:

URGENT:Security Update Required

Text

HTML

Hello user, please click the link to secure your account.<https://learn.cylabacademy.org/get-started>

☐ Add Tracking Image

 Add Files

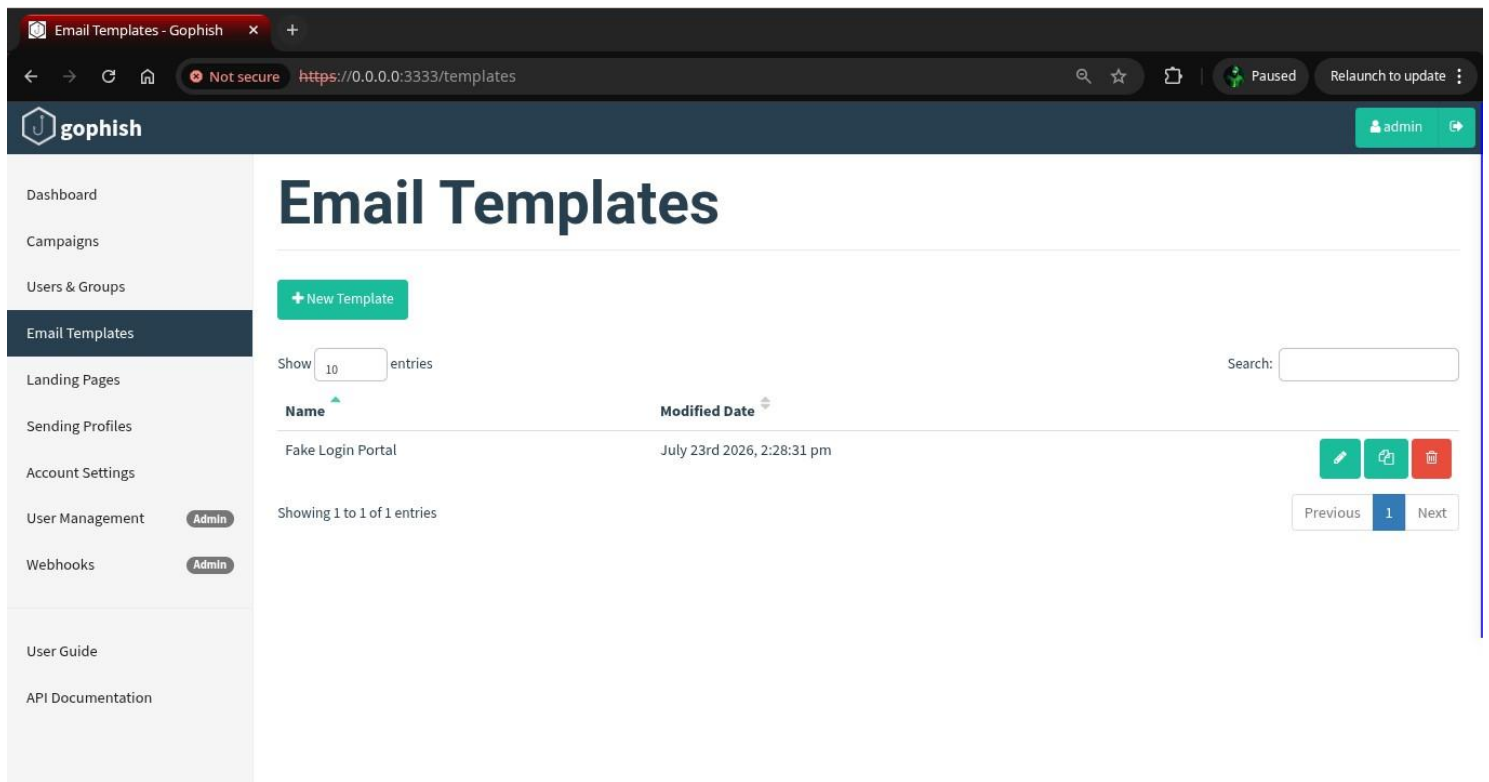
Show

10

 entries

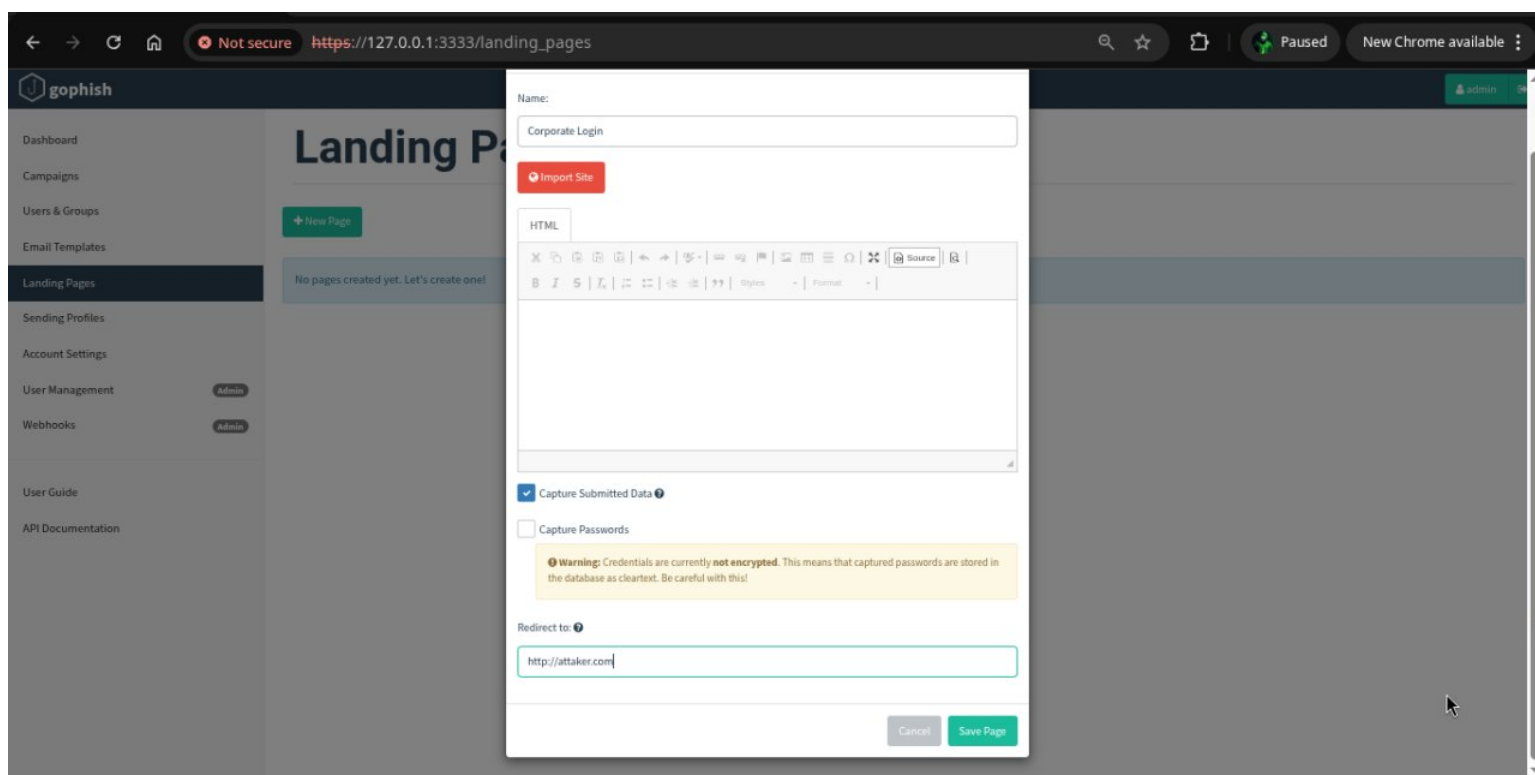
Search:

Name 



Step 4: Configure the Landing Page

1. Open **Landing Pages**.
2. Click **New Page**.
3. Import or create the Google login page.
4. Enable:
 - Capture Submitted Data
 - Capture Passwords
5. Configure the redirect URL after login google.com
6. Save the landing page.



Step 5

1. Open **Users & Groups**.
2. Click **New Group**.
3. Add the target users.

Name	Email
Bob Wilson	bob.wilson@robotech.local
Jane Smith	jane.smith@robotech.local
John Doe	john.doe@robotech.local
Abreham Abebe	abrehamabebe1921@gmail.com

4. Save the group.

Email abrehamabebe@1921 is my real email and used for a demo for educational purpose only to look the sent email.

Name:

Test Users

[+ Bulk Import Users](#) [Download CSV Template](#)

First Nam Last Nam Email Position [+ Add](#)

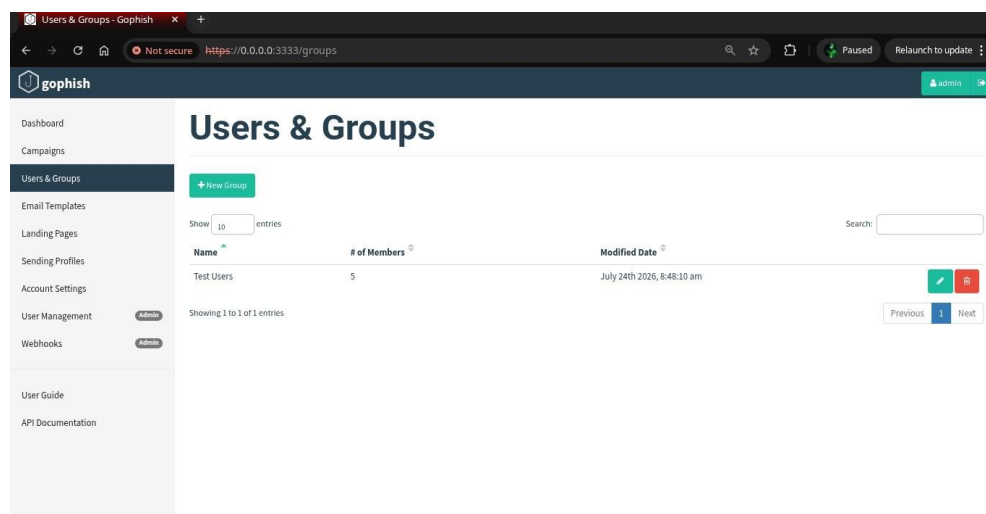
Show entries Search:

First Name	Last Name	Email	Position
bob	wlison	bob.wlison@ro...	
Jane	smith	jane.smith@rob...	
John	doe	john.doe@robo...	

Showing 1 to 3 of 3 entries

Previous **1** Next

[Close](#) [Save changes](#)

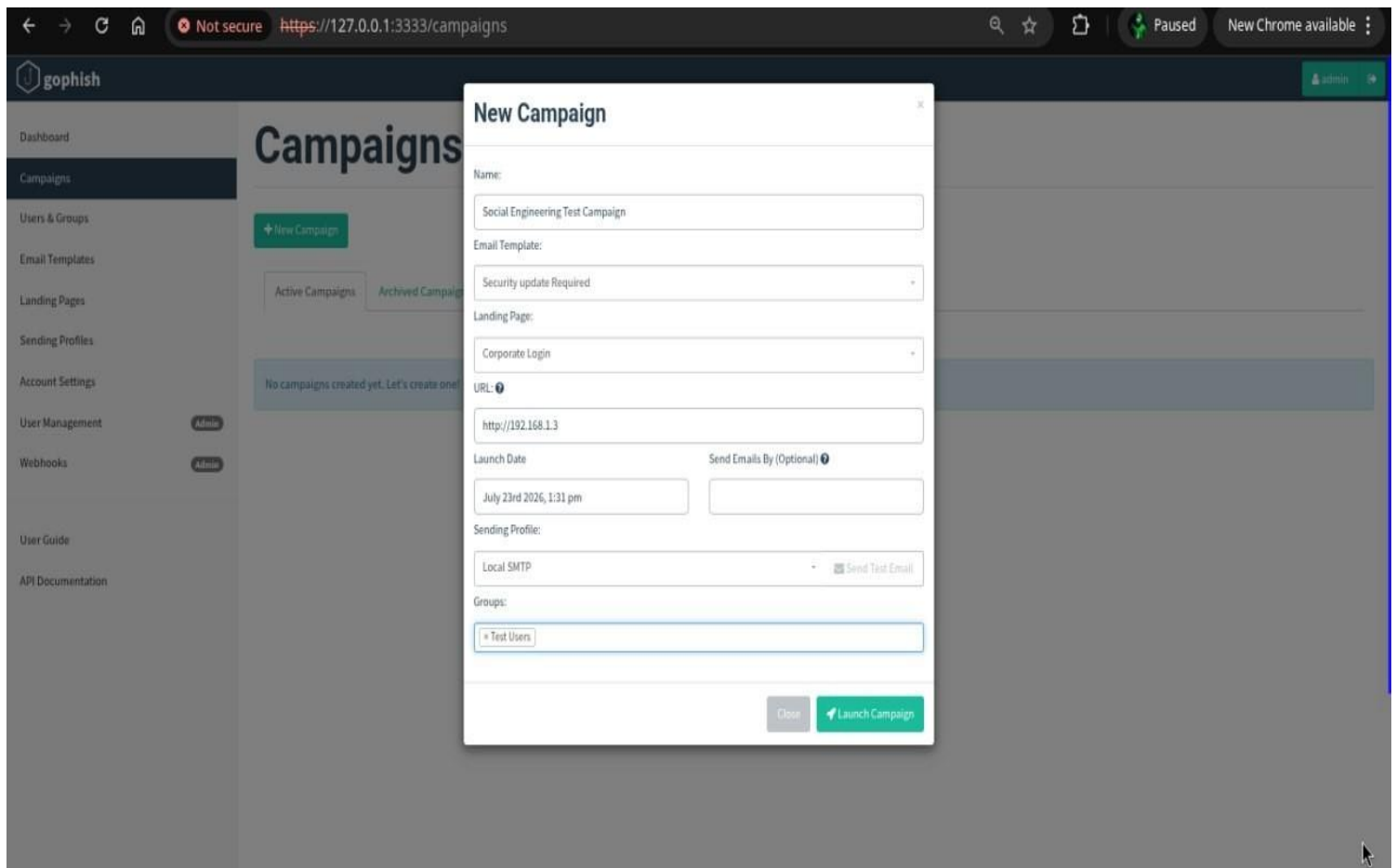


Step 6: Launch the Phishing Campaign

1. Open **Campaigns**.
2. Click **New Campaign**.
3. Configure:

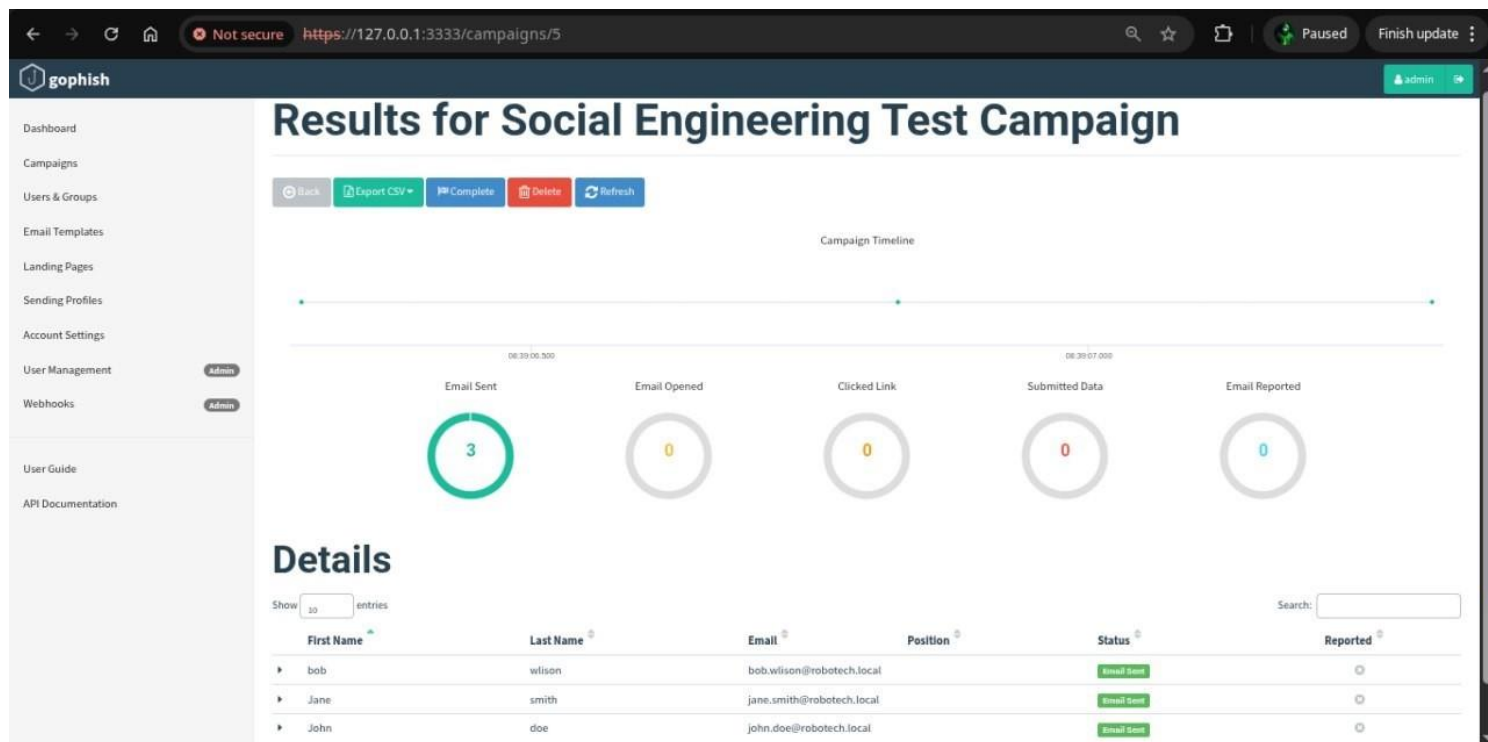
Setting	Value
Campaign Name	Social Engineering Test Campaign
Email Template	Fake login page
Landing Page	Fake login Portal
Group	Test Users
URL	account.https:// learn.cylabacademy.org/get-started

4. Click **Launch Campaign**.

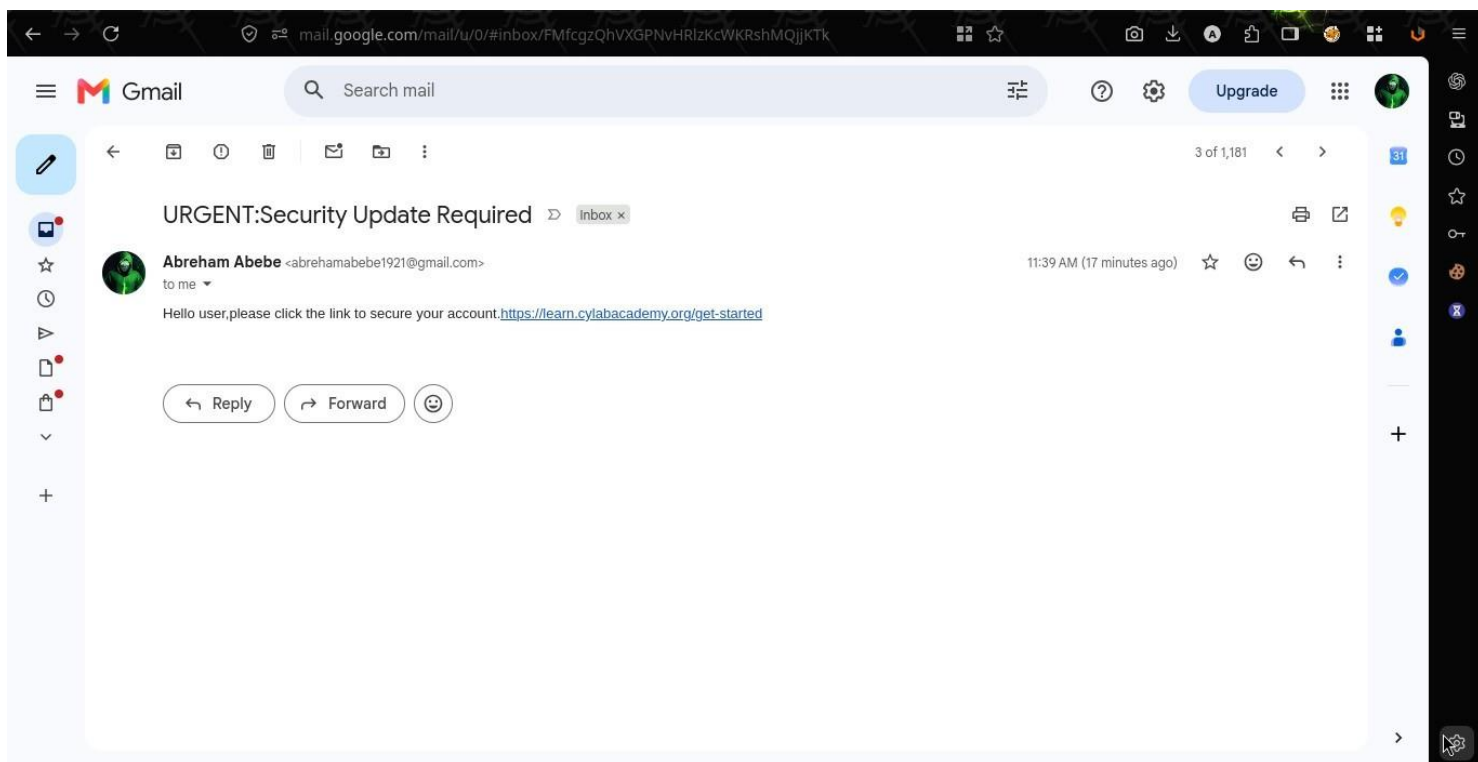


Step 7: Monitor Campaign Results

1. Observe campaign statistics from the GoPhish dashboard.
2. Monitor:
 - Emails Sent
 - Emails Opened
 - Link Clicks
 - Credentials Submitted
 - Email Status
3. Review campaign timelines and event logs.



Email abrehamabebe@1921 is my real email and used for a demo for educational purpose only to look the sent email.



Analysis Questions:

- How does Zphisher differ from SET in terms of templates?
- What makes these templates convincing?
- What defensive measures could detect these pages?

ANSWER

1. How does GoPhish provide better campaign management than SET or Zphisher?

Answer:

GoPhish is designed for phishing awareness campaigns and provides centralized management and detailed reporting. It tracks email delivery, opens, clicks, and submitted credentials, while supporting user groups, email templates, and multiple campaigns.

In comparison:

- **SET** focuses on phishing attacks and payload generation with limited campaign management.
- **Zphisher** provides phishing page templates but lacks a dashboard, campaign tracking, and reporting features.

Therefore, GoPhish is the most suitable tool for professional phishing awareness training and campaign management.

2. What metrics are most valuable for assessing phishing effectiveness?

The most valuable metrics are:

- **Delivery Rate** – Emails successfully delivered.
- **Open Rate** – Emails opened by recipients.
- **Click Rate** – Users who clicked the phishing link.
- **Credential Submission Rate** – Users who entered credentials.
- **Reporting Rate** – Users who reported the phishing email.

These metrics help measure user awareness and the effectiveness of phishing simulations.

3. How could an organization use this for security awareness training?

Organizations can use GoPhish to conduct controlled phishing simulations, measure employee awareness, identify users who need additional training, track improvement over time, and strengthen defenses against real-world phishing attacks. It also supports ongoing security awareness and compliance programs.

Defensive Countermeasures

To reduce the risk of phishing attacks, organizations should:

- Enable Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA).
- Verify email sender addresses and URLs before entering credentials.
- Conduct regular phishing awareness training.
- Use secure email gateways to filter phishing emails.
- Monitor authentication logs for suspicious activity.

- Encourage users to report suspicious emails promptly.

Conclusion

This exercise demonstrated how GoPhish can be used to simulate a phishing campaign in a controlled laboratory environment. By configuring an SMTP server, creating phishing emails and landing pages, and monitoring campaign results, the exercise showed how organizations can evaluate user awareness and strengthen defenses against phishing attacks through regular training and monitoring.